

MEETING NOTES

Rules and Policy Subcommittee Meeting

Tuesday, December 6, 2022 @ 4:30 PM

Via Zoom

Agenda

As approved by the committee on January 24, 2022 (2022-5): The Rules and Policy Subcommittee will review The Bullying Prevention and Intervention Plan for recommended updates.

Attendance: Member Ruseau, Member Graham, Member McLaughlin – 3/0

- All members are present and quorum confirmed:
Marice Edouard-Vincent, Nick Tucci, John Bruno, Paul D'Alleva, Andrew O'Brien, Cherose Walker, Katie Fiumara, Kirk Johnson, Nicole Branley, Suzanne, Shannon Demos, Mike Downs, Ms. Lalli, Dave Blauch, Jill Story, Chad Fallon, Mitzi Galante
- Referencing original document from 2010, Revised August 2014, November 2020
- Member McLaughlin asked as to where to find the google doc.

Nicole Branley:

- has read the doc multiple times.
- Had not seen the document previously; did not know it existed
- Claims it has not been followed
- Very hard to see there is paperwork that has not been followed
- Thinks what is in the plan is great, but if not following through it means nothing
- Must be other people out there who have had similar experiences
- More than willing to help for the future of our city and community

Member McLaughlin:

- There is a lot to digest in the document
- Visual flow chart would help families understand the process
- Was unaware of the bullying report form
- Cathy Medaglio gave a professional training for parents to understand
- Document needs to be translated
- Professional training and family training to be developed to address the needs

Member Graham:

- The document is indigestible as it stands
- SC does not have an actual bullying policy and we need one
- Believes it needs to be owned by the Superintendent and the administration
- When families find themselves dealing with the circumstances, it is important to have a concise (1-page) plan
- Need regular meetings to address what bullying is
- When unpleasant situations arise, it needs to be determined as to what the definition of bullying is
- Help bridge the gap with family to educate and empower through policy and plan to communicate consistency and follow through on the plan
- Make sure people know we have a policy and we are following through on enforcing the policy
- Encourage people to speak and remind people to remember to protect the children involved
- Consistency is critical

Michael Downs:

- what is the difference between conflict and bullying
- Make people more aware
- Be aware of how social media is being used to communicate the issue publicly
- If it is bullying, it takes a long time to investigate
- Be aware of how social media is being used to communicate the issue publicly

Member Graham:

- There is a need to determine the difference between conflict and bullying
- Queries a migration from conflict to bullying
- Are we being proactive on the progression from conflict to bullying
- From an education perspective, investigations take a long time
- While an investigation needs to be thorough, it needs also to be addressed swiftly and thoroughly
- What are parent communications? The family of a victim should have a clear understanding of where the process is and what they can expect to receive for information
- How can we make sure the families are supported
- Have to figure out what the models are using conflict resolution as a place to speak about curriculum
- There is going to be change as to the approach the school is taking

Nicholas Tucci

- Speaks to the training his teachers are taking . Each school year starts with training on what bullying is
- restorative circles have begun being used
- Proactive to help the students understand bullying and reporting and understand adults
- Active and visible in the student body ... any time an issue does arise, maintain a collaborative environment
- Sandy Hook Promise Say Something rollout and reporting anonymously

Superintendent Marice Edouard-Vincent::

- proactive measures at lower grade levels (responsive classrooms, NEXIS and color coding for behavior control)
- Restorative circles / responsive classrooms helps students be better regulated

Member McLaughlin:

- IEPs include bullying plans and information given to families, and training
- Incidents that are related to a disability are highly regulated/legislated
- People should be offered access to resources
- Flow chart was created last year as we worked with Joan Bowen and Dr. Cushing

Shannon Demos:

- We really do instill that at a young age
- Initiated morning meetings and responsive classrooms across the district so students can feel safe
- Last year - learning curve
- Spoke to Michigan model

Member Graham:

- student feedback on NEXIS was not great
- where are those related resources for families to understand and speak the same language
- Wonders if there are any ways to help parents help their kids speak to their emotions and engage their students through language and capacity

Suzanne Galusi

- we are in year 2 of NEXIS, meeting every week to review curriculum and ongoing feedback
- create connectors with home
- Shifts focus to teachers to make them aware how to bring it back into their classrooms
- Sandy Hook Start with Hello in elementary

Member Paul Ruseau:

- will need to review the law to ensure we are including all required elements, some of what is in this plan may only be there because it is mandated
- curriculum on bullying is part of the HECAT process
- It appears the document was written in two parts and needs to be reviewed by Legal
- Michigan model - cannot predict where this will go

Member Melanie McLaughlin:

- recommends we have a shared document we all edit together

Paul D'Alleva;

- Are we able to use the document as a group?

Superintendent Marice Edouard-Vincent:

- will speak with legal to ensure we have the key pieces in the plan

Dr. Peter Cushing

- The model adhere to the state guidelines

Member Rousseau:

- the document needs to be made relevant
- Get rid of all the redundancy in the document
- What makes sense is to make some recommendations and edits

Member McLaughlin:

- Recommends a shared collaborative google doc would be helpful to bring back to the next meeting

Member Rousseau:

- the document needs to be edited in public session
- Be reviewed by legal counsel (Howard)

Member McLaughlin:

- Not comfortable taking out big chunks of information from the document

Member Rousseau:

- Will speak to Howard

Paul D-Alleva:

- Come up with a final document based off of the various edits

Member Rousseau:

- Public needs to have access to the document

Member Graham:

- Assumes superintendent will coordinate and build out the plan with her team
- May want to think about how to engage in the process
- The Policy ... open meeting law
- Draft of a Policy - do we first start with a policy?
- Presenter cannot update the plan until there is a policy in place

Member Ruseau:

- Has to be approved every 5 years
- If 'we' don't write a policy, the superintendent will write
- Believes the SC needs to write policy

Member McLaughlin:

- Set aside the plan to be approved by the SC
- Should be focusing on policy first
- Superintendent focuses on the plan
- SC role is to hire and evaluate the superintendent and approving material - policy in particular
- Agrees w/Member Graham to focus on policy first

Superintendent Marice Edouard-Vincent:

- Will work with administrators and legal counsel to confirm what portions where the language should remain within the plan

Member Ruseau:

- Wasn't looking to change the language

Member McLaughlin:

- Please share links for other documents PR has researched from other communities
- What other districts are working well and are similar to medford

Eunice Browne:

- The community needs to know what is the difference between a plan and a policy

Member Ruseau:

- Law was explicitly called Preventions and Intervention Plan
- The plan is the policy
- Some school districts have both

Nicole Branley:

- Sat in close to 100 NEXIS classes
- High school need more; there is a disconnect there
- Doesn't feel like the terms are relevant to older children and language will not be used
- We need to be proactive
- It is our (SC) responsibility (job) to study and review the document
- Lots of duplication in the document
- If we don't cover every base, it could be the one word that could make a difference
- Needs to be pushed to the upper levels, where the kids rule

- There are no bad children, no unexpected behavior

Member Ruseau:

- Staff needs to know the policy and plan in order to

Member Graham:

- **Want** vs. the **How**
- **Policy** is a **Want**
- How will it happen is **the Plan**
- Need to find a compromise that does not compromise the **Want**

Member Ruseau:

Takeaways:

- Translations - visual flowchart - definitions of conflict is missing and needs to be added
- Shared screen of copy of Bullying document

District Bullying and Cyberbullying Policy Guidelines

The new state anti-bullying law requires that school districts create bullying prevention plans. The Medford Public Schools Bullying Prevention and Intervention Plan (PDF) was approved by the Medford School Committee on Monday, December 20, 2010 and was revised in October 2011. The following guidelines were revised in August 2014 and as most recently in November 2020.

It is the policy of the Medford Public Schools to provide a learning environment that is free from bullying and cyberbullying (similar policies exist and define sexual harassment and hazing). It is a violation of this policy for any student to engage in bullying or cyberbullying, or for any employee of the Medford Public Schools to condone or fail to report acts of bullying or cyberbullying that they witness or become aware of (i) on school grounds and property immediately adjacent to school grounds; (ii) at school-sponsored or school-related activities, functions or programs, whether on or off school grounds; (iii) at school bus stops; (iv) on school buses or other vehicles owned, leased or used by the school district; or (v) through the use of technology or an electronic device owned, leased or used by the school district.

It is also a violation of this policy for any student to engage in bullying or cyberbullying at a location, activity, function or program that is not school-related, or through the use of technology or an electronic device that is not owned, leased or used by the school district, if the bullying creates a hostile environment at school for the victim, infringes on the rights of the victim at school, or materially and substantially disrupts the education process or orderly operation of the school, as determined by school administrators.

The MPS School District will not tolerate retaliation against a person who reports bullying or cyberbullying, provides information during an investigation of bullying or cyberbullying, or witnesses or has reliable information about bullying or cyberbullying.

- Speaks to the history of bullying
- Need to begin work on the policy
- Find out if we can work on a google doc together as a group of members

- Shared some of the links to other policies at other districts

<https://docs.google.com/document/d/1vLU4ItKdHPBrliwXkGwAYoBnwqfrChTepoowycRMWOY/edit>

<https://z2policy.ctspublish.com/masc/browse/lexingtonset/lexington/JICFB>

<https://drive.google.com/file/d/1ZZFNszsAfENe2EiXZxYqxHkZ5Aqh634c/view>

<https://maldenps.org/wp-content/uploads/2022/06/MPS-Bullying-Prevention-and-Intervention-Plan-Final-Mar-2022.pdf>

Member Ruseau:

- Thanks everyone for attending
- Next meeting to be scheduled 2nd-3rd week in January
- Questions and comments can be directed to Member Ruseau via email
- Called for an adjournment

Motion to adjourn by Member Paul Ruseau

MEETING ADJOURNED: 5:45PM